

Your Coronary CTA

Why this test?

Coronary CTA uses CT and IV contrast to show artery anatomy, plaque and estimated narrowing. It answers a different question from a calcium scan.

How to prepare

Tell the team about kidney disease, prior iodinated-contrast reactions, pregnancy possibility and all medicines, including erectile-dysfunction drugs. Follow their food, caffeine and medication instructions.

What to expect

You receive contrast through an IV and follow breath-hold instructions. The team may give medicines to improve image quality. The scan uses radiation and has potential contrast-related risks.

What happens next?

Your clinician considers narrowing, plaque and image quality. Not every plaque finding needs a procedure. Ask what changes about prevention, symptoms or further testing.

Questions to bring

- What question will CCTA answer in my case?
- Do my kidneys, contrast history or medicines affect preparation?
- What do the findings change about my care?

My next step / follow-up: _____

Urgent symptoms: Call 911 for severe chest symptoms, fainting, stroke symptoms or severe trouble breathing. Do not wait for a scheduled test or its report.

Full guide and references: <https://bmorecardiology.com/tests/coronary-cta.html>

Source: [ACR/RSNA RadiologyInfo: Coronary CTA](#)

Source: [ACC: 2023 Guideline for Managing Chronic Coronary Disease](#)

Independent educational resource. Use your own clinician's instructions.